Whatever might have been the outcome in Bangalore, Kaarthikeyan succeeded in nailing the LTTE and securing the conviction of the assassins right up till the Supreme Court.

AMIT VERMA (37): SP, CBI-Delhi

Amit Verma was a 1978-batch IPS officer from the Tamil Nadu cadre and was handpicked by the director of the CBI, Vijay Karan, for his notable experience in Tamil Nadu before joining the CBI and cracking cases such as that of the forged letter by Devi Lal, the HDW (Howaldtswerke-Deutsche Werft) submarine deal, the army chief General Vaidya's assassination and then eventually catching the most dreaded Khalistani terrorist Harjinder Singh 'Jinda'. While many officers refused to join the SIT fearing political interference, Verma instantly thanked Vijay Karan for giving him the opportunity. He was known for his courage and perseverance, and for owning a sharp detective's mind. Somehow, he had an inkling that the LTTE was involved in Rajiv Gandhi's assassination from the moment he heard about it. I was present with him at that moment. Verma, along with DSP K. Ragothaman from the Madras (now Chennai) branch of the CBI, became the face of the field investigation. He would be present at every raid, interrogation of the key accused, examination of important clues and liaising with the Tamil Nadu forensics lab, which didn't see eye to eye with the SIT. But his SIT journey was a bumpy one when it came to picking up various leads. At times, he was at loggerheads with some of his seniors on the direction of the investigation. He wanted to pursue the larger conspiracy theory about what was beyond the LTTE, but the SIT management never allowed him to do that. His proposed trip to France to investigate LTTE man Pushpraj, the alleged foreign link of the mastermind Sivarasan, was rejected. He eventually took up the matter with his additional director, S.K. Datta, who promised Verma an 'opportunity at an appropriate time'. And Datta kept his word. He sent him to the Jain Commission, which later inquired into the larger conspiracy angle.

Verma passed away in June 2010 in Tamil Nadu.